Ma‘ṣūma went to Balkh at that time. At some point in AD 1517, Babur is said to have visited Balkh, as reported by Khwānd-amīr.[14]

b) Attempt on Qandahār

In this year, Babur set out on a march toward Qandahār. However, this particular move concluded peacefully due to an unexpected illness that befell him when he was near the town. The illness appears to have led to negotiations, gifts, and terms that prevented a military confrontation.

The Tārīkh-i-sind provides what is claimed to be Shāh Beg's explanation for Babur's repeated attempts to capture Qandahār. According to Shāh Beg, Babur's persistence in seeking Qandahār was motivated by his inability to forgive Muqīm for capturing Kābul from the Tīmūrid ‘Abdu'r-razzāq fourteen years earlier. This event had brought Babur to Qandahār in AD 1507 and led to the removal of Māhchuchak, Muqīm's daughter. Furthermore, by AD 1517, there were many unemployed Mīrzās in Kābul for whom suitable positions could not be found in regions where the Persians and Aūzbegs held sway. Seeking an outlet for their ambitions and those of Babur, they looked toward a confrontation with a weaker adversary.

Babur's decision to launch an attack in this year was reportedly made while Shāh Beg was still a prisoner in the custody of Shāh Ismā'īl in the Herāt region. However, Shāh Beg must have been released by that time, possibly due to the patient efforts of his servant Saṃbhal.

13 January of 1518 to 3 January of AD 1519

During this year, Shāh Beg's son, Shāh Ḥasan, arrived at Bābur's court after a quarrel with his father. Shāh Ḥasan remained in Babur's service for approximately two years. During this period, he was married to Gul-barg, the daughter of Khalīfa. His return to Qandahār likely occurred shortly before Babur's renewed campaign against the city in AD 1520, which ultimately led to Babur's capture of Qandahār on Shawwāl thirteenth (6 September of AD 1522).[15]

In this year, the campaign in the northeastern territories of Kābul commenced, and an account of these events is continued in the diary for AD 1519. It appears that during this year, Chaghān-sarāī and the fortress at the head of the Bābā-qarā valley, which belonged to Ḥaidar-i-'alī Bajaurī, were captured.[*]